

PERSONAL STATEMENT

I am Rohit Ramdas Kokane, a Computer Science undergraduate at Sanjivani University with a strong interest in Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Large Language Models (LLMs). I am motivated by the opportunity to apply my academic knowledge to real-world research and to learn from researchers working on challenging problems in modern AI. The MTL Fellowship represents an opportunity for me to strengthen my research skills, explore new ideas, and contribute meaningfully to a laboratory working in an area aligned with my interests.

During my studies, I have developed a foundation in programming, data structures and algorithms, databases, operating systems, computer networks, and artificial intelligence. I have also gained practical experience through projects and internships. In particular, during my internship as an LLM Intern at Ethara AI from February to May 2026, I worked with LLM-related tasks and gained exposure to model training and evaluation workflows. This experience increased my interest in understanding how AI systems learn, perform, and can be improved through systematic experimentation.

I am particularly interested in research that connects machine learning with practical applications and intelligent systems. I want to develop a deeper understanding of how modern language models are trained, evaluated, and adapted for different tasks. I believe that working in a research laboratory would help me move beyond implementation alone and develop the ability to formulate research questions, analyze results, read scientific literature, and communicate technical findings clearly.

I would bring curiosity, consistency, a willingness to learn, and hands-on programming experience to the fellowship. I am comfortable learning new technologies independently and working through unfamiliar technical problems. At the same time, I understand that research requires patience, critical thinking, careful experimentation, and openness to feedback. I am eager to learn from the members of my preferred MTL Fellow laboratory and contribute wherever my skills can be useful.

My long-term goal is to build a career in AI and machine learning, with a particular interest in LLMs and intelligent software systems. I see the MTL Fellowship as an important opportunity to gain research exposure, work in an academically rigorous environment, and understand how impactful AI research is conducted. I would be grateful for the opportunity to contribute to the laboratory, learn from its researchers, and use the experience to develop into a stronger AI researcher and engineer.